

L2A™

(b) Discuss the meaning, scope and relevance of Economic Anthropology

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Economic anthropology describes, analyses and interprets the economic life in socio-cultural context at all places and at all times.

Nash (1968): economic anthropology studies economy as a subsystem of the society.

History and Development

1) Malinowski in his work 'Argonauts of Western Pacific (1922)' studied Kula exchange among Trobriand islanders.

2) Karl Polanyi in 'The Great Transformation (1944)' talked about mode of exchange among simple economies.

3) ~~Herskovits~~ Herskovits in 'Economic Anthropology (1960)' studied economic system of various tribes.

Scope

- 1) studying mode of consumption, distribution and production at various levels.
- 2) social roles score over economic ones in tribal society (eg: Kula exchange)
- 3) Role of tribal market in tribal economy.
- 4) ~~how economic relations impact various social inst~~
- 4) Impact of various social institutions like marriage, family, kinship on economic relations.

Relevance

- 1) Studying the impact of colonialism and new global forces like globalisation on tribal economy.

Paul Bohanan in 'African Markets' ~~system~~
(1960)

studied the impact of colonialism on Nandi,
Leela etc.

- 2) Tribal society ~~can be~~ cannot be studied in isolation. Economic anthropology helps to study societies as whole holistically.
- 3) Helps in formulation of ~~with~~ policies for tribal development.
- 4) We can learn a lot from tribals regarding environment conservation & ~~maintaining~~ maintaining harmony with help of economic anthropology.

Economic anthropology studies societies in a holistic manner. Its interdisciplinary approach makes it a frontier science.

Attempted
Well